

Job Title/Position: *Palliative Care Nurse Practitioner*

Reports To: *Clinical Director*

JOB DESCRIPTION SUMMARY

The Palliative Care Nurse Practitioner is a registered professional nurse with advanced graduate education and clinical training who provides comprehensive home care services in compliance with the state Nurse Practice Act. He/She provides palliative care through the evaluation and assessment of the health history, health promotion, diagnosing medical conditions, management of health problems by directing and developing the plan of care, prescribing medications or treatments, coordinating and collaborating with patients, families and other healthcare practitioners. Under the supervision of a physician, the nurse practitioner visits patients, completes physical assessments, performs face to face assessments, as appropriate, and begins the development of the palliative care plan of care in consultation with the palliative care interdisciplinary team. The nurse practitioner builds from the resources of the community to plan and direct services to meet the need of individuals and families within their homes and communities.

ESSENTIAL JOB FUNCTIONS/RESPONSIBILITIES

Patient Care

1. Provides medical care, palliates and manages terminal illness in compliance with the state Nurse Practice Act.
2. Completes history and physical examinations, by evaluating the patient's medical condition and health history, ordering and interpreting results from laboratory and diagnostic tests or procedures, diagnosing health conditions and documents the findings in the patient's medical record.
3. Manages acute and chronic health conditions and terminal illnesses by developing an individualized plan of care, prescribing medications (to the extent permitted by licensure) and or treatments, obtaining consultations or making referrals and coordinating hospice care services.
4. Reviews clinical information, coordinates and oversees patient care in consultation with the palliative care interdisciplinary team and other healthcare practitioners.
5. Assures that patient receives appropriate measures to control symptoms through collaboration with interdisciplinary team members.
6. Reviews and develops protocols for treatment and proposes options for interventions based on the current medical literature.
7. Consults the collaborating physician or organizational leadership when the patient's plan of care is outside standardized practice and protocols.

Job Title/Position: *Palliative Care Nurse Practitioner*

Communication

1. Communicates and collaborates with the interdisciplinary group to create, review and revise the patient's plan of care.
2. Consults with the patient's attending physician, the palliative care Physician and other healthcare practitioners regarding the ongoing care needs and medical management related to the patient's life-limiting illness, condition or injury.
3. Communicates with other community health practitioners to coordinate the plan of care.
4. Attends and participates in palliative care interdisciplinary group meetings.
5. Completes, maintains and submits accurate and relevant clinical notes, physical examination notes, assessment visit notes, medical orders, collaboration notes and other documentation in the medical record.
6. Educates/counsels patients, families, and/or caregivers as to preventative care, medical problems, psychological problems, and spiritual problems in conjunction with the interdisciplinary team to meet the total needs of patients.
7. Provides and maintains a safe environment for the patient.
8. Assists the patient and family/caregiver and other team members in providing continuity of care.
9. Provides information and education about advance care planning to the patient and family as appropriate.
10. Works in cooperation with the family/caregiver and palliative interdisciplinary group to identify the goals of care and meet the care needs of the patient and family/caregiver.
11. Serves as a nursing resource for consultation and educations to members of the interdisciplinary team and other healthcare practitioners in the community.
12. Establishes, builds and nurtures relationships with staff and community referral sources to facilitate program growth.

Additional Duties

1. Maintains knowledge of and compliance with current Medicare/Medicaid, state/federal rules and regulations for palliative care services
2. Ensures compliance with the Medicare conditions of participation and other state regulations govern the provision of healthcare.
3. Complies with all Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act (HIPAA) requirements in accordance with federal, state and organizational policies.

Job Title/Position: *Palliative Care Nurse Practitioner*

4. Participates in organizational monitoring of the quality of medical services and quality improvement initiatives.
5. Assumes responsibility for personal growth. Develops, maintains and upgrades professional knowledge and practice skills through attendance at seminars, conferences and participation in continuing education and in-service classes.
6. Fulfills the obligation of requested and/or accepted assignments.
7. Demonstrate knowledge in communication and counseling patient/family in dealing with end-of-life issues.

POSITION QUALIFICATIONS

1. Graduation from an accredited School of Nursing and accredited Nurse Practitioner Program.
2. Current nursing licensure in State and CPR certification, as required by organizational policy.
3. Master's degree with a minimum of one (1) year Nurse Practitioner experience who has training in palliative care and/or hospice care; clinical experience in hospice or palliative care; or one who has, or is eligible for, palliative care certification.
4. Pediatrics: Must have experience and/or training in the developmental stages and needs of infants, children and adolescents.
5. Accreditation from an approved certifying body for advanced practice nursing as required by State.
6. Certification in a specialist area preferred; (e.g. Hospice and Palliative Nursing (CHPN), Pediatrics or Geriatrics).
7. Excellent observation, verbal and written communication skill, problem solving skills, mathematical skills; nursing skills per competency checklist.
8. Prolonged or considerable walking or standing. Able to lift, position and/or transfer patients. Able to lift supplies and equipment. Considerable reaching, stooping, bending, kneeling and/or crouching. Visual acuity and hearing to perform required nursing skills.
9. Must be a licensed driver with an automobile that is insured in accordance with state/or organization requirements and is in good working order.

Employee Signature

Date